Installing and getting started with Node.js

Node.js is a platform for executing JavaScript in an event-driven environment so you can easily build network applications. To install Node.js, visit https://nodejs.org and download the package that fits your OS. All examples in this book are tested with Node.js 14.

After Node.js is installed, you can verify that everything works by typing `node --version` into your terminal. Your terminal should respond with something similar to `v14.*`. Now you're ready to run JavaScript examples like URL2PNG.

Do you want to get started with Node.js? We recommend *Node.js in Action* (second edition) by Alex Young et al. (Manning, 2017), or the video course *Node.js in Motion* by PJ Evans (Manning, 2018).

Here's how the message is produced with the help of the AWS SDK for Node.js; it will be consumed later by the URL2PNG worker. The Node.js script can then be used like this (don't try to run this command now—you need to install and configure URL2PNG first):

```
$ node index.js "http://aws.amazon.com"
PNG will be available soon at
http://url2png-$yourname.s3.amazonaws.com/XYZ.png
```

As usual, you'll find the code in the book's code repository on GitHub https://github.com/AWSinAction/code3. The URL2PNG example is located at /chapter14/url2png/. The next listing shows the implementation of index.js.

Listing 14.4 index.js: Sending a message to the queue

```
const AWS = require('aws-sdk');
var { v4: uuidv4 }  = require('uuid');
const config = require('./config.json');
```